

Conservation Biology Student Grant Proposal Assignment

Modeled after the AZA Conservation Grants Fund (CGF)

Assignment Overview

In this assignment, you will **develop a short conservation grant proposal** modeled on the [Association of Zoos & Aquariums \(AZA\) Conservation Grants Fund](#).

Your proposal should describe a **hypothetical or real conservation project** that integrates **in situ** and/or **ex situ** components consistent with the *One Plan Approach*.

The purpose of this assignment is to help you:

- Practice structuring a concise and persuasive conservation proposal.
- Apply course concepts (biodiversity, threats, management, and restoration).
- Connect theoretical conservation biology principles with applied conservation practice.

Instructions

1. Choose a **species, habitat, or conservation issue** relevant to the course.
2. Your project should fit one or more of these categories:
 - Field conservation (in situ)
 - Animal or population management (ex situ)
 - Conservation education and engagement
 - Research or applied science
3. Submit your proposal via Canvas as a **PDF** or **Word document**.

Recommended length: ~3–4 pages total (including cover sheet and references).

Scope Reminder:

Your project should be achievable within a one-year timeline and a modest seed-grant budget. Proposals should emphasize *feasible actions*, *measurable outcomes*, and *clear conservation value* over scope or scale.

Proposal Components

Cover Sheet

Provide a concise summary of your project.

Required information:

- **Title of Project**
- **Student Name**
- **Institution:** University of Nebraska at Omaha
- **Project Duration:** (e.g., October 2025 – September 2026)
- **Project Category:** (choose two)
 - ☐ Field Conservation
 - ☐ Animal/Population Management
 - ☐ Conservation Education/Engagement
 - ☐ Research

Project Abstract

Limit 250 words. Briefly describe what your project aims to do, the problem it addresses, and its expected conservation impact.

Project Narrative

Answer the following questions clearly and concisely.

1. **Project Overview & Significance** What conservation issue or biological question does your project address?
Why is it important for conservation or management?

2. **Goals, Objectives, and Actions** Identify your long-term goal, immediate objectives, and the key actions you will take to meet those objectives.
3. **Methods** Describe how you will carry out your project.
If research-oriented, outline your study design and data collection.
If applied or educational, specify the audience and implementation steps.
4. **Timeline** Present a short timeline or list of milestones covering your one-year project duration.
5. **Evaluation & Outcomes** How will you determine if the project met its objectives?
Include measurable indicators of success (quantitative or qualitative).
6. **Dissemination** How will you share your results or communicate your impact (e.g., outreach, poster, report, social media, or collaboration with a zoo or NGO)?
7. **Ethical and Welfare Considerations** If animals are involved, how will you ensure appropriate care and welfare standards are met?
(If not applicable, write “N/A.”)

Budget

Provide a simple table summarizing projected expenses. **Your total budget may not exceed \$20,000.**

Budget Item	Cost Estimate	Description
Travel (field site or zoo)	\$_____	e.g., fuel, vehicle rental
Supplies	\$_____	field gear, printing, software
Equipment	\$_____	binoculars, camera trap, lab kits
Outreach Materials	\$_____	educational posters, brochures
Total	\$_____	

Budget Justification (1–2 paragraphs): Explain why each expense is necessary for achieving your objectives and how you would prioritize spending if partial funding were available.

References

List any literature, reports, or species action plans you consulted. Choose your academic format, but keep it consistent (APA, CSE, or similar).

Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	Points	Description
Project relevance & conservation significance	15	Connects clearly to course concepts and demonstrates conservation need.
Goals, objectives, and methods	15	Well defined, realistic, and appropriate for a one-year scope.
Feasibility & clarity	10	Project is coherent, feasible, and clearly written.
Integration of One Plan principles	10	Links in situ and ex situ components or broader conservation strategy.
Budget efficiency & justification	5	Demonstrates realistic and well-prioritized spending relative to objectives.
Creativity & professionalism	5	Writing quality, formatting, and adherence to guidelines.

Total: 60 points

Submission

Upload your final document to the canvas by **December 8 at 4:00 PM**.